Persist Week of August 3, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com. We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x

Monday, August 3rd, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Curl
Six sets of six on the barbell curl with 45 to 60 seconds between sets. The short rest is the point. The biceps do not get a full recovery between sets, which means each set accumulates on the last. Pick a weight that sits around RPE 7 or 8 on the first set. By set five and six the biceps will be working hard to maintain the same reps and tempo.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
3. Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Stiff Leg Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Supinated Bent Over Row
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo (Aim for 8+ reps)
Loading Note: For this training cycle, the barbell bent over row will be increasing in reps throughout the 6 weeks. The Max Unbroken set from two weeks prior will support you in determining which weight to start with for this week.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
Lat Pulldown or Pronated Strict Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 3 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Loading Note: Immediately following your last working set, perform a single drop set to failure. This means that you will drop the weight by 30% and complete max reps unbroken. If performing pull ups, add band assistance and aim for 5+ reps on your drop set.

F) Finisher (8 min):
6 sets:
Barbell Curl
Every 45-60sec x 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
Loading Note:
Select a weight that feels about RPE 7-8 on the first set.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday, August 4th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Sidelying Powell Raise + Cuban Press
Two shoulder accessory movements done back to back with a short rest between them. The sidelying Powell raise works the back of the shoulder through a slow, controlled arc. Keep the movement strict and let the shoulder do the work. The Cuban press follows and trains the shoulder through a pressing arc that the bigger lifts earlier in the session never reach. Use lighter weights on both. The goal is to get close to failure on each set and build volume in the parts of the shoulder that the main pressing work misses.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
3. Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Alternating Dumbbell Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Cable Tricep Push Down or Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 12 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Narrow Grip Tricep Push Up; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

For the push ups you may take small breaks as needed. The reps on the tricep exercise are increasing from week 2.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Sidelying Powell Raise on Bench; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Cuban Press; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
3. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 5th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Windshield Wiper + Hollow Body Hold
Two core movements that work rotation and full body tension back to back. The windshield wiper swings the legs side to side while keeping the upper back pinned to the floor. Control the movement the whole way down. Do not let gravity do the work. The hollow body hold that follows keeps everything tight at once: legs up, lower back flat, arms long. The goal on both is to stay in control the whole time. The moment form breaks, the set is over.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
2. Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
B Stance Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 7 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10
Loading Note: The reps are increasing from Week 2. Aim to match Week 2 weights with the addition of 1 rep, but if needed you may decrease weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Kettlebell Rack Curtsy Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. DB Suitcase Standing Calf Raise; 12-15 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Windshield Wipers; 5-7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Hollow Body Hold; 20-30 sec
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, August 6th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 30 sec Glute Bridge March
- 15 Tuck Ups
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
- 20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Friday, August 7th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
1-1/4 Dumbbell Curl + Supine Crush Grip Tricep Extension
Two arm movements done back to back with a short rest between them. The 1-1/4 curl adds an extra quarter rep at the bottom of each rep, which keeps the bicep loaded at the hardest part of the range longer than a standard curl. The supine crush grip tricep extension that follows works the tricep with the elbows pointed up while lying flat. Keep the upper arms still throughout. Push close to failure on both each set.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Plyo Push Up; 5 reps
3. Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Barbell Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Back Supported Arnold Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Incline Bench Dumbbell Upright Row; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Incline Bench Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 sets
1. 1-1/4 Dumbbell Curl; 6-10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Supine Crush Grip Tricep Extension; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
3. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, August 8th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Heel Tap + DB Side Plank Rotations
A rotational movement paired with a weighted anti-rotation hold. The heel tap trains the obliques through a controlled lowering pattern. The DB side plank rotation that follows loads the same lateral line while the core is already fatigued. Keeping the dumbbell moving through its full arc without letting the hips drop is where the real work is. Push close to failure on both movements each set.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Weight Plate Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
3. Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Landmine Hack Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. 45 Degree Back Extension or 45 Degree Back Extension Alternative; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec
2. Plate Loaded Leg Behind Squat; 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Heel Tap; 10-15 reps/side
rest 45 sec
2. DB Side Plank Rotations; 8-10 reps/side
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Heel Sits; 10 reps
2. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday, August 9th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

I want to share something that took me longer to figure out than I'd like to admit.

For a period of time, I was chasing lean. I wanted to be as lean as possible and I structured a lot of my training and eating around that goal. On the surface it looked like discipline. But underneath it, something was off. My energy was low. My relationship with food got complicated. I found myself thinking about my body in ways that weren't healthy, and honestly, I wasn't even performing that well. I was smaller, but I wasn't better.

What I've learned since is that leanness as a primary goal has a ceiling, and below that ceiling things can get pretty dark. Low body fat sustained over time has real physiological costs. Hormonal disruption, poor recovery, diminished strength. But it also has psychological costs that don't get talked about enough. The constant monitoring, the fear of losing what you worked for, the way it can quietly take over how you see yourself.

Strength is a better north star. When I shifted my focus to what my body could do instead of what it looked like, everything changed. The leanness came back, but as a byproduct, not a target. And I felt like myself again.

If you're currently in a place where aesthetics are driving every decision, it's worth asking what it's

actually costing you.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, August 3rd, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Sidelying Powell Raise + Cuban Press
Two shoulder accessory movements done back to back with a short rest between them. The sidelying Powell raise works the back of the shoulder through a slow, controlled arc. Keep the movement strict and let the shoulder do the work. The Cuban press follows and trains the shoulder through a pressing arc that the bigger lifts earlier in the session never reach. Use lighter weights on both. The goal is to get close to failure on each set and build volume in the parts of the shoulder that the main pressing work misses.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
3. Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Supinated Bent Over Row
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 12 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo (Aim for 8+ reps)
Loading Note:
For this training cycle, the barbell bent over row will be increasing in reps throughout the 6 weeks. The Max Unbroken set from two weeks prior will support you in determining which weight to start with for this week.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Cable Tricep Push Down or Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 12 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Narrow Grip Tricep Push Up; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. For the push ups you may take small breaks as needed. The reps on the tricep exercise are increasing from week 2.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Sidelying Powell Raise on Bench; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Cuban Press; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
3. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday, August 4th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Windshield Wiper + Hollow Body Hold
Two core movements that work rotation and full body tension back to back. The windshield wiper swings the legs side to side while keeping the upper back pinned to the floor. Control the

movement the whole way down — do not let gravity do the work. The hollow body hold that follows keeps everything tight at once: legs up, lower back flat, arms long. The goal on both is to stay in control the whole time.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
2. Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
B Stance Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 7 reps/side @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10
Loading Note:
The reps increase starting in Week 2. Aim to match Week 2 weights by adding 1 rep, but if needed, you may decrease the weight.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Kettlebell Rack Curtsy Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. DB Suitcase Standing Calf Raise; 12-15 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Windshield Wipers; 5-7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Hollow Body Hold; 20-30 sec
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 5th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Thursday, August 6th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
1-1/4 Dumbbell Curl + Supine Crush Grip Tricep Extension
Two arm movements done back to back with a short rest between them. The 1-1/4 curl adds an extra quarter rep at the bottom of each rep, which keeps the bicep loaded at the hardest part of the range longer than a standard curl. The supine crush grip tricep extension that follows works the tricep with the elbows pointed up while lying flat. Keep the upper arms still throughout. Push close to failure on both each set.

Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Plyo Push Up; 5 reps
3. Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Barbell Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (8 min):
Lat Pulldown or Pronated Strict Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 3 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Immediately following your last working set, perform a single drop set to failure. This means that you will drop the weight by 30% and complete max reps unbroken. If performing pull ups, add band assistance and aim for 5+ reps on your drop set.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 Working Sets
1. Alternating Dumbbell Bench Press; 8 reps/side @30X0
rest 30 sec
2. Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. 1-1/4 Dumbbell Curl; 6-10 reps @20X0 Tempo

rest 45 sec
2. Supine Crush Grip Tricep Extension; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
3. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, August 7th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Heel Tap + DB Side Plank Rotations
A rotational movement paired with a weighted anti-rotation hold. The heel tap trains the obliques through a controlled lowering pattern. The DB side plank rotation that follows loads the same lateral line while the core is already fatigued. Keeping the dumbbell moving through its full arc without letting the hips drop is where the real work is. Push close to failure on both movements each set.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Weight Plate Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
3. Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Stiff Leg Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. 45 Degree Back Extension or 45 Degree Back Extension Alternative; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Plate Loaded Leg Behind Squat; 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Heel Tap; 10-15 reps/side
rest 45 sec
2. DB Side Plank Rotations; 8-10 reps/side
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Heel Sits; 10 reps
2. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, August 8th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 30 sec Glute Bridge March
- 15 Tuck Ups
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk

x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
- 20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip External Rotation
1. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
2. Supine Figure 4 Stretch x 1-2 min/side
3. Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side
5. Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5-10 reps/side
6. Elevated Pigeon Stretch x 1-2 min/side
7. Sidelying Active Hip ER x 5 reps/side

Sunday, August 9th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

I want to share something that took me longer to figure out than I'd like to admit.

For a period of time, I was chasing lean. I wanted to be as lean as possible and I structured a lot of my training and eating around that goal. On the surface it looked like discipline. But underneath it, something was off. My energy was low. My relationship with food got complicated. I found myself thinking about my body in ways that weren't healthy, and honestly, I wasn't even performing that well. I was smaller, but I wasn't better.

What I've learned since is that leanness as a primary goal has a ceiling, and below that ceiling things can get pretty dark. Low body fat sustained over time has real physiological costs. Hormonal disruption, poor recovery, diminished strength. But it also has psychological costs that don't get talked about enough. The constant monitoring, the fear of losing what you worked for, the way it can quietly take over how you see yourself.

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If you're currently in a place where aesthetics are driving every decision, it's worth asking what it's

actually costing you.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, August 3rd, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Russian Twist + Side Plank
Two core movements done back to back with a short rest between them. The Russian twist trains the obliques through a controlled rotational pattern. Keep the feet off the floor and the torso back at a consistent angle through every rep. The side plank that follows holds the lateral line under sustained tension while the core is already fatigued. Stay long from head to heel and do not let the hips drop. Push close to failure on both movements each set.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
3. Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Supinated Bent Over Row
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 12 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight/assistance and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo (Aim for 8+ reps)

Loading Note:
For this training cycle, the barbell bent over row will be increasing in reps throughout the 6 weeks. The max unbroken set from two weeks ago will help you determine which weight to start with this week.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Kettlebell Rack Curtsy Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. B Stance Barbell Hip Thrust; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Heel Tap; 10-15 reps/side
- rest 45 sec
2. DB Side Plank Rotations; 8-10 reps/side
- rest 45 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. Middle Split; 30-60 sec
3. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, August 4th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip External Rotation
1. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
2. Supine Figure 4 Stretch x 1-2 min/side
3. Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side
5. Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5-10 reps/side
6. Elevated Pigeon Stretch x 1-2 min/side
7. Sidelying Active Hip ER x 5 reps/side

Wednesday, August 5th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Sidelying Powell Raise + Cuban Press
Two shoulder accessory movements done back to back with a short rest between them. The sidelying Powell raise works the back of the shoulder through a slow, controlled arc. Keep the movement strict and let the shoulder do the work. The Cuban press follows and trains the shoulder through a pressing arc that the bigger lifts earlier in the session never reach. Use lighter weights on both. The goal is to get close to failure on each set and build volume in the parts of the shoulder that the main pressing work misses.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
2. Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (8 min):
Lat Pulldown or Pronated Strict Pull Up

Every 2:30 x 3 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Immediately following your last working set, perform a single drop set to failure. This means that you will drop the weight by 30% and complete max reps unbroken. If performing pull ups, add band assistance and aim for 5+ reps on your drop set.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Cable Tricep Push Down or Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 12 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Narrow Grip Tricep Push Up; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. For the push ups you may take small breaks as needed. The reps on the tricep exercise are increasing from week 2.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Sidelying Powell Raise on Bench; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 45 sec
2. Cuban Press; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Tall Kneeling Triceps Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, August 6th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or, if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip External Rotation
1. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
2. Supine Figure 4 Stretch x 1-2 min/side
3. Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side
5. Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5-10 reps/side
6. Elevated Pigeon Stretch x 1-2 min/side
7. Sidelying Active Hip ER x 5 reps/side

Friday, August 7th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Curl
Six sets of six on the barbell curl with 45 to 60 seconds between sets. The short rest is the point. The biceps do not fully recover between sets, which means each set adds to the last. Pick a weight that sits around RPE 7 or 8 on the first set. By sets five and six, the biceps will be working hard to maintain the same reps and tempo.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
3. Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Stiff Leg Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Barbell Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. 45 Degree Back Extension or 45 Degree Back Extension Alternative; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Plate Loaded Leg Behind Squat; 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (8 min):
6 sets
Barbell Curl
Every 45-60sec x 6 reps @20X0 Tempo
Loading Note:
Select a weight that feels about RPE 7-8 on the first set.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Saturday, August 8th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 30 sec Glute Bridge March
- 15 Tuck Ups
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality

- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
- 20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
3. Banded Shoulder Extension x 10 reps
4. Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
5. Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
6. PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10 reps

Sunday, August 9th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

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Strength is a better north star. When I shifted my focus to what my body could do instead of what it looked like, everything changed. The leanness came back, but as a byproduct, not a target. And I felt like myself again.

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Warmly,

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Pump Condition 5x

Monday, August 3rd, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Stiff Leg Deadlift
The stiff leg deadlift keeps the legs nearly locked, which shifts the load almost entirely onto the hamstrings and glutes. The bar stays close to the body on the way down and the hips hinge back until the hamstrings reach their end range. Reps vary across the three working sets this week. Each drop in reps means the weight goes up. Use straps here. The weights are heavy enough that grip will become the limiter before the hamstrings do, and the goal is to keep the demand on the posterior chain, not the hands.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Sprint Hinge Core based on your goals.

A) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
3. Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

B) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Stiff Leg Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Balance (10 min):
Every 75 sec x 6 rounds (3 sets each)
1. Pendlay Row; 7 reps @30X0 Tempo
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up; 3 reps @21X1 Tempo

Loading Note:
Pull Up and Pendlay Row reps are heavy this week with the goal of pushing the intensity on both

movements. Aim for the first set of each to be about RPE 7-8. Then you can increase or keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets based on how much intensity you are wanting to push today. The Pendlay Row has increased in reps from Week 3, and aim to match the same weight. The Pull Up has decreased in reps from Week 3, aim to increase weight or decrease assistance. This format is 3 sets of each movement.

D) Sprint Hinge Core (15 min):
4 Sets
Row 6-10 Calories @ HIGH TEMPO
rest 15sec
Right Arm Single Arm Russian Swings x 8 reps
Left Arm Single Arm Russian Swings x 8 reps
rest 15sec
Tuck L Sit or L Sit x 20-30sec
rest walk 90sec
Effort Note:
The goal for this conditioning is to push the pace on the cardio machine. The intensity should start relatively high and increase each set. The additional movements should be performed at a consistent but hard pace. The rest is intentional to allow for the higher outputs.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday, August 4th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Close Grip Bench Press
The close grip bench press brings the elbows closer to the body, which shifts the load from the chest onto the triceps. Four sets building from RPE 7 to a max unbroken drop set. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up. By the max unbroken set at the end, the triceps will have been under load for a long time. Use that set to find out how much the cycle has built.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or High Turnover Push based on your goals.

A) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
3. Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

B) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating DB Bench Press; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Cable Tricep Push Down or Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

D) High Turnover Push (12 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories (Male/Female) @ high effort
8-15 Wide Grip Push Ups Unbroken
Move immediately into the next couplet
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort
6-8/side Plank to Alternating Toe Touch
Effort Note:
Complete each set as fast as possible, leaving a little gas in the tank for the next set. Aim to complete each set 30-45 seconds of rest before starting the next set.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
3. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 5th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Back Squat
The back squat alternates with the cyclist version across this cycle. Without the heel elevation the demand shifts from the quads toward the posterior chain and requires more hip and ankle mobility to stay in good positions. Reps drop from the previous back squat week, which means the weight goes up. Four working sets building to RPE 9. Take your time between sets and treat the warmup seriously before the working weight goes on.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Ab + Leg Pump based on your goals.

A) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
2. Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

B) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

C) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Kettlebell Rack Curtsy Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. B-Stance Barbell Hip Thrust; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

D) Functional Ab + Leg Pump (12-15 min):
5mins As Many Reps As Possible AMRAP
5 Hand Release Burpees
7 GHD Sit Ups
12 Air Squats
rest 2mins x 2 Sets
Effort Note:
This is a bodyweight conditioning piece that will maintain a consistently high pace throughout the

workout. Start at a sustainable pace and gradually build up throughout the first 5 minute AMRAP. For the second AMRAP, complete as many total rounds and reps as possible.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, August 6th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 30 sec Glute Bridge March
- 15 Tuck Ups
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
- 20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Friday, August 7th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Strict Press
The barbell strict press alternates with the Seated Filly Press across this cycle. This week, the load is bilateral, and the reps drop from Week 2, which means the weight goes up. No leg drive, no lean back. The press should come entirely from the shoulders and triceps. The max unbroken drop set at the end is the final ask of each session. Use Set 1 weight and go until form breaks.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Fatigued Shoulders based on your goals.

A) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Plyo Push Up; 5 reps
3. Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

B) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Barbell Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Incline Bench Dumbbell Upright Row; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Incline Bench Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

D) Fatigued Shoulders (15 min):
For Time:
40/32 Calorie Row (Male/Female)
10 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up
50ft/side Mixed Front Rack Overhead Kettlebell Carry
30/24 Calorie Row
8 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up
50ft/side Mixed Front Rack Overhead KB Carry

20/16 Calorie Row
6 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up
50ft/side Mixed Front Rack Overhead KB Carry
*KB Weight Suggestion 53/35\#
Effort Note:
This conditioning piece is highly fatiguing for the shoulders. If you are between weights, opt for a lighter weight. You can break up the reps as needed, but try to keep rest to a minimum during the shoulder exercises. Use the row to catch your breath and allow your shoulders to recover.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
3. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, August 8th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
The back rack reverse lunge alternates with the Zercher split squat across this cycle. The load on the back shifts the center of gravity, placing greater demand on the core to keep the torso upright as you step back. Keep the front shin vertical and bring the back knee close to the floor on every rep. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Carry Conditioning based on your goals.

A) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Weight Plate Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
3. Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

B) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets
1. 45 Degree Back Extension or 45 Degree Back Extension Alternative; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Plate Loaded Leg Behind Squat; 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

D) Carry Conditioning (12-15 min):
2-3 Sets For Quality
60sec Row @ High Effort
20 Box Jump Step Down
30sec/side Single Arm Farmer's Walk
rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Select a weight that is challenging, but you are able to complete it unbroken for at least the first set. Start this workout at a sustainable pace. Increase the pace each round if you are feeling good.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Heel Sits; 10 reps
2. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday, August 9th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

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Pump Condition 4x

Monday, August 3rd, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Close Grip Bench Press
The close grip bench press brings the elbows closer to the body, which shifts the load from the chest onto the triceps. Four sets building from RPE 7 to a max unbroken drop set. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up. By the max unbroken set at the end, the triceps will have been under load for a long time. Use that set to find out how much the cycle has built.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or High Turnover Push based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
3. Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
Every 3:30 x 3 Working Sets
1. Lat Pulldown or Pronated Strict Pull Up; 8-10 reps @20X1 Tempo
directly into
1. Supinated Bent Over Row; 6-8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest until the remainder of the 3:30
Loading Note:
Perform the pulldown or pull up and then go immediately to the bent over row. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7-8 and then keep weight the same or increase weight based on the intensity you want to push today. The reps are staying the same for this cycle with the goal of increasing weight.

E) High Turnover Push (12 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories (Male/Female) @ high effort
8-15 Wide Grip Push Ups Unbroken
Move immediately into the next couplet
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories (Male/Female) @ high effort
6-8/side Plank to Alternating Toe Touch
Effort Note:
Complete each set as fast as possible leaving a little gas in the tank for the next set. Aim to complete each set 30-45 seconds rest before starting the next set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
3. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday, August 4th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
The back squat alternates with the cyclist version across this cycle. Without the heel elevation the demand shifts from the quads toward the posterior chain and requires more hip and ankle mobility to stay in good positions. Reps drop from the previous back squat week, which means the weight goes up. Four working sets building to RPE 9. Take your time between sets and treat the warmup seriously before the working weight goes on.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Ab + Leg Pump based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
2. Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Kettlebell Rack Curtsy Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. B-Stance Barbell Hip Thrust; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Functional Ab + Leg Pump (12-15 min):
5mins As Many Reps As Possible AMRAP
5 Hand Release Burpees
7 GHD Sit Ups
12 Air Squats
rest 2mins x 2 Sets
Effort Note:
This is a bodyweight conditioning piece that will maintain a consistently high pace throughout the workout. Start at a sustainable pace and gradually build up throughout the first 5 minute AMRAP. For the second AMRAP, complete as many total rounds and reps as possible.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 5th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Thursday, August 6th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Strict Press
The barbell strict press alternates with the Seated Filly Press across this cycle. This week, the load is bilateral, and the reps drop from Week 2, which means the weight goes up. No leg drive, no lean back. The press should come entirely from the shoulders and triceps. The max unbroken drop set at the end is the final ask of each session. Use Set 1 weight and go until the form breaks.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Fatigued Shoulders based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Plyo Push Up; 5 reps
3. Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Barbell Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating DB Bench Press; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Cable Tricep Push Down or Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Fatigued Shoulders (15 min):
40/32 Calorie Row (Male/Female)
10 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up
50ft/side Mixed Front Rack Overhead Kettlebell Carry
30/24 Calorie Row (Male/Female)
8 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up
50ft/side Mixed Front Rack Overhead KB Carry
20/16 Calorie Row (Male/Female)
6 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up
50ft/side Mixed Front Rack Overhead KB Carry
*KB Weight Suggestion 53/35\#
Effort Note:
This conditioning piece is highly fatiguing for the shoulders. If you are between weights, opt for a lighter weight. You can break up the reps as needed, but try to keep rest to a minimum during the shoulder exercises. Use the row to catch your breath and allow your shoulders to recover.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
3. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, August 7th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Stiff Leg Deadlift
The stiff leg deadlift keeps the legs nearly locked, which shifts the load almost entirely onto the hamstrings and glutes. The bar stays close to the body on the way down and the hips hinge back

until the hamstrings reach their end range. Reps vary across the three working sets this week. Each drop in reps means the weight goes up. Use straps here. The weights are heavy enough that grip will become the limiter before the hamstrings do, and the goal is to keep the demand on the posterior chain, not the hands.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Carry Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Weight Plate Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
3. Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Stiff Leg Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. 45 Degree Back Extension or 45 Degree Back Extension Alternative; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Plate Loaded Leg Behind Squat; 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Carry Conditioning (12-15 min):
2-3 Sets For Quality
60sec Row @ High Effort
20 Box Jump Step Down
30sec/side Single Arm Farmers Walk
rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Select a weight that is challenging, but you are able to complete unbroken for at least the first set. Start this workout at a sustainable pace. Increase pace each round if you are feeling good.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Heel Sits; 10 reps

2. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, August 8th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 30 sec Glute Bridge March
- 15 Tuck Ups
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
- 20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip External Rotation
1. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
2. Supine Figure 4 Stretch x 1-2 min/side
3. Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side
5. Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5-10 reps/side
6. Elevated Pigeon Stretch x 1-2 min/side
7. Sidelying Active Hip ER x 5 reps/side

Sunday, August 9th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

I want to share something that took me longer to figure out than I'd like to admit.

For a period of time, I was chasing lean. I wanted to be as lean as possible and I structured a lot of

my training and eating around that goal. On the surface it looked like discipline. But underneath it, something was off. My energy was low. My relationship with food got complicated. I found myself thinking about my body in ways that weren't healthy, and honestly, I wasn't even performing that well. I was smaller, but I wasn't better.

What I've learned since is that leanness as a primary goal has a ceiling, and below that ceiling things can get pretty dark. Low body fat sustained over time has real physiological costs. Hormonal disruption, poor recovery, diminished strength. But it also has psychological costs that don't get talked about enough. The constant monitoring, the fear of losing what you worked for, the way it can quietly take over how you see yourself.

Strength is a better north star. When I shifted my focus to what my body could do instead of what it looked like, everything changed. The leanness came back, but as a byproduct, not a target. And I felt like myself again.

If you're currently in a place where aesthetics are driving every decision, it's worth asking what it's actually costing you.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, August 3rd, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Close Grip Bench Press
The close grip bench press brings the elbows closer to the body, which shifts the load from the chest onto the triceps. Four sets building from RPE 7 to a max unbroken drop set. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up. By the max unbroken set at the end, the triceps will have been under load for a long time. Use that set to find out how much the cycle has built.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Ab + Leg Pump based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side

3. Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
Every 3:30 x 3 Working Sets
1. Lat Pulldown or Pronated Strict Pull Up; 8-10 reps @20X1 Tempo
directly into
1. Supinated Bent Over Row; 6-8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest until the remainder of the 3:30
Loading Note:
Perform the pulldown or pull up and then go immediately to the bent over row. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7-8 and then keep weight the same or increase weight based on the intensity you want to push today. The reps are staying the same for this cycle with the goal of increasing weight.

E) Functional Ab + Leg Pump (12-15 min):
5mins As Many Reps As Possible AMRAP
5 Hand Release Burpees
7 GHD Sit Ups
12 Air Squats
rest 2mins x 2 Sets
Effort Note:
This is a bodyweight conditioning piece that will maintain a consistently high pace throughout the workout. Start at a sustainable pace and gradually build up throughout the first 5 minute AMRAP. For the second AMRAP, complete as many total rounds and reps as possible.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, August 4th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Wednesday, August 5th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
The back squat alternates with the cyclist version across this cycle. Without the heel elevation the demand shifts from the quads toward the posterior chain and requires more hip and ankle mobility to stay in good positions. Reps drop from the previous back squat week, which means the weight goes up. Take your time between sets and treat the warmup seriously before the working weight goes on.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or High Turnover Push based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
2. Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. B-Stance Barbell Hip Thrust; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Alternating Dumbbell Curl; 8-10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) High Turnover Push (12 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories (Male/Female) @ high effort
8-15 Wide Grip Push Ups Unbroken
Move immediately into the next couplet
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories (Male/Female) @ high effort
6-8/side Plank to Alternating Toe Touch
Effort Note:
Complete each set as fast as possible, leaving a little gas in the tank for the next set. Aim to complete each set 30-45 seconds of rest before starting the next set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
3. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday, August 6th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip External Rotation
1. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
2. Supine Figure 4 Stretch x 1-2 min/side
3. Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side

5. Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5-10 reps/side
6. Elevated Pigeon Stretch x 1-2 min/side
7. Sidelying Active Hip ER x 5 reps/side

Friday, August 7th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Stiff Leg Deadlift
The stiff leg deadlift keeps the legs nearly locked, which shifts the load almost entirely onto the hamstrings and glutes. The bar stays close to the body on the way down, and the hips hinge back until the hamstrings reach their end range. Reps vary across the three working sets this week. Each drop in reps means the weight goes up. Use straps here. The weights are heavy enough that grip will be the limiting factor before the hamstrings do, and the goal is to keep the demand on the posterior chain, not the hands.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Carry Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
3. Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Stiff Leg Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Strict Press; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Incline Bench Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Carry Conditioning (12-15 min):
2-3 Sets For Quality
60sec Row @ High Effort
20 Box Jump Step Down
30sec/side Single Arm Farmers Walk
rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Select a weight that is challenging, but you are able to complete it unbroken for at least the first set. Start this workout at a sustainable pace. Increase the pace each round if you are feeling good.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Heel Sits; 10 reps
2. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, August 8th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 30 sec Glute Bridge March
- 15 Tuck Ups
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
- 20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
3. Banded Shoulder Extension x 10 reps

4. Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
5. Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
6. PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10 reps

Sunday, August 9th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

I want to share something that took me longer to figure out than I'd like to admit.

For a period of time, I was chasing lean. I wanted to be as lean as possible and I structured a lot of my training and eating around that goal. On the surface it looked like discipline. But underneath it, something was off. My energy was low. My relationship with food got complicated. I found myself thinking about my body in ways that weren't healthy, and honestly, I wasn't even performing that well. I was smaller, but I wasn't better.

What I've learned since is that leanness as a primary goal has a ceiling, and below that ceiling things can get pretty dark. Low body fat sustained over time has real physiological costs. Hormonal disruption, poor recovery, diminished strength. But it also has psychological costs that don't get talked about enough. The constant monitoring, the fear of losing what you worked for, the way it can quietly take over how you see yourself.

Strength is a better north star. When I shifted my focus to what my body could do instead of what it looked like, everything changed. The leanness came back, but as a byproduct, not a target. And I felt like myself again.

If you're currently in a place where aesthetics are driving every decision, it's worth asking what it's actually costing you.

Warmly,
Marcus

Perform

Monday, August 3rd, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Stiff Leg Deadlift
The stiff leg deadlift alternates with the conventional across this cycle. Keeping the legs straighter shifts more demand onto the hamstrings and requires more range of motion through the hip hinge. The bar travels closer to the legs on the way down — keep it in contact the whole way. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Run, Hinge, Core based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
3. Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
3 Hang Snatch
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Stiff Leg Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
Every 3:30 x 3 Working Sets
1. Lat Pulldown or Pronated Strict Pull Up; 8-10 reps @20X1 Tempo
directly into

1. Supinated Bent Over Row; 6-8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest until the remainder of the 3:30
Loading Note:
Perform the pulldown or pull up and then go immediately to the bent over row. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7-8 and then keep weight the same or increase weight based on the intensity you want to push today. The reps are staying the same for this cycle with the goal of increasing weight.

F) Run, Hinge, Core (12 min):
6mins AMRAP
150/100m Run (Male/Female)
14 Toes to Bar
14 (7/side) Alternating Single Arm Split Stance Russian Swing (70/53\#)
rest 1min and repeat for a total of 2 sets (12 mins of total work)
Effort Note:
Aim for a consistent and sustainable pace. All runs should be about the same pace and both AMRAP should be about the same number of rounds/reps.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday, August 4th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Close Grip Bench Press
The close grip bench press alternates with the incline version across this cycle. The narrower grip shifts more of the demand onto the triceps and inner chest compared to a standard press. Keep the elbows from flaring too wide. The close grip only works if the path stays tight. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Chest + Core Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
3. Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Cyclical Hot Start (8 min):
Bike

Every 60 sec x 8 sets
10 sec @95% effort
50 sec @easy pace
Effort Note:
Push the pace during the 10 seconds and recover for the remainder of the minute. The pace can gradually increase throughout the 10 minutes as the body warms up. The goal is to improve upon your total cals/distance from Week 1.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Close Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating DB Bench Press; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Cable Tricep Push Down or Dumbbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Chest + Core Conditioning (12-15 min):
For Time
500/400m Row (Male/Female)
4 rounds
8/side Alternating Dumbbell Bench Press
6 Alternating Single Leg Strict Toes to Bar
20-15-10
Ring Push Up
Tuck Ups
500/400m Row
Effort Note:
The two rows bookend the pressing and core work. Use the first row to find a pace that leaves enough in the tank for the pressing sets that follow. Break the ring push ups early rather than grinding to failure as they come when the chest and shoulders are already fatigued. Push the final row with whatever remains.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
3. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 5th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
The back squat alternates with the cyclist version across this cycle. Without heel elevation the demand shifts more into the posterior chain and requires more forward lean to maintain depth. The 22X1 tempo means two seconds down, two second pause at the bottom, then drive. That pause removes any bounce out of the hole and keeps every rep honest. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Power Endurance based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
2. Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15-18 min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
3 Power Clean
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Kettlebell Rack Curtsy Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. B-Stance Barbell Hip Thrust; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Power Endurance (15 min):
15min As Many Reps As Possible AMRAP
5 Weighted Hanging Leg Tuck 35/20\# (Male/Female)
4 Strict Ring Dips
3 Box Jump 36/30"
2 Power Snatch 135/105\#
Effort Note:
Keep the quality high throughout this AMRAP. The pace should feel sustainable from the start to the end.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, August 6th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 30 sec Glute Bridge March

- 15 Tuck Ups
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
- 20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Friday, August 7th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Strict Press
The barbell strict press alternates with the Seated Filly Press across this cycle. The strict press uses both arms together under a barbell, which allows more total load overhead than the single arm version. Keep the core braced and avoid leaning back through the press. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Push Pull Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Plyo Push Up; 5 reps
3. Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Jerk Progression (12 min):
5 working sets; rest 90 sec between sets
2 Pause Split Jerk

Set 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Barbell Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Incline Bench Dumbbell Upright Row; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Incline Bench Lateral Raise; 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Push Pull Conditioning (15 min):
15min As Many Reps As Possible AMRAP @ 85% Effort
6 Strict Dips or Strict HSPU or Pike Strict HSPU
8 Kipping Chest to Bar Pull Ups
10 Hand Release Push Ups
600/480m Bike (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
Aim to accumulate a lot of quality reps by not hitting failure too soon into the AMRAP. Allow your upper body fatigue to dictate how you are breaking up sets. Push the pace on the bike as your breathing will likely be less of a problem than your upper body fatigue.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
3. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, August 8th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
The back rack reverse lunge alternates with the Zercher split squat across this cycle. The reverse lunge steps back rather than forward, which reduces knee stress and keeps more demand in the glute and hamstring of the front leg. The back rack position allows more total load than the Zercher. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Couple of Couplets based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Weight Plate Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
3. Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Aerobic KB Skills (9-12 min):
9-12 mins EMOM Format
1st - 40 sec AMRAP Double Unders
2nd - 40sec AMRAP Kettlebell Russian Twist
3rd - 40sec Single Arm KB Clean + Jerk (switch sides at 20 sec)
Effort Note:
Select a weight and pace that allows you to practice pacing and KB skill without overly fatiguing yourself for the sections of training to come.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. 45 Degree Back Extension or 45 Degree Back Extension Alternative; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Plate Loaded Leg Behind Squat; 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Couple of Couplets (12-15 min):

For Time
10-9-8-7-6-5
Cal Bike (Female Rx Cals = 7-7-6-6-5-5)
DB Front Squat
into
10-9-8-7-6-5
Cal Bike (Female Rx Cals = 7-7-6-6-5-5)
*20sec Switch Lunge after each set
Effort Note:
Try to find a pace that is challenging but sustainable. This format allows for you to find a great rhythm.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Heel Sits; 10 reps
2. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday, August 9th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

I want to share something that took me longer to figure out than I'd like to admit.

For a period of time, I was chasing lean. I wanted to be as lean as possible and I structured a lot of my training and eating around that goal. On the surface it looked like discipline. But underneath it, something was off. My energy was low. My relationship with food got complicated. I found myself thinking about my body in ways that weren't healthy, and honestly, I wasn't even performing that well. I was smaller, but I wasn't better.

What I've learned since is that leanness as a primary goal has a ceiling, and below that ceiling things can get pretty dark. Low body fat sustained over time has real physiological costs. Hormonal disruption, poor recovery, diminished strength. But it also has psychological costs that don't get talked about enough. The constant monitoring, the fear of losing what you worked for, the way it can quietly take over how you see yourself.

Strength is a better north star. When I shifted my focus to what my body could do instead of what it looked like, everything changed. The leanness came back, but as a byproduct, not a target. And I felt like myself again.

If you're currently in a place where aesthetics are driving every decision, it's worth asking what it's actually costing you.

Warmly,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, August 3rd, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Dumbbell Bench Press
The dumbbell bench press alternates with the incline version across this cycle. The flat position shifts more of the demand onto the mid chest compared to the incline. Four sets building from RPE 7 to a max unbroken drop set. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or High Turnover Push based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
3. Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Dumbbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
Every 3:30 x 3 Working Sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up; 8-10 reps @20X1 Tempo
directly into
1. Supinated DB Bent Over Row; 6-8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest until the remainder of the 3:30

Loading Note:
Perform the pull up and then go immediately to the bent over row. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7-8 and then keep weight the same or increase weight based on the intensity you want to push today. The reps are staying the same for this cycle with the goal of increasing weight.

E) High Turnover Push (12 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
8-15 Wide Grip Push Ups Unbroken
8-12 Burpee
Move immediately into the next couplet
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
40-50 Double Unders or 60-75 Single Unders
6-8/side Plank to Alternating Toe Touch
Effort Note:
Complete each set as fast as possible leaving a little gas in the tank for the next set. Aim to complete each set 30-45 seconds rest before starting the next set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
3. Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday, August 4th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Front Squat
The dumbbell front squat alternates with the cyclist goblet version across this cycle. The front load position demands more core engagement to stay upright and keeps the quads working hard even without heel elevation. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Ab + Leg Pump based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
2. Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 7 reps @22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 reps @22X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Kettlebell Rack Curtsy Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. B-Stance Dumbbell Hip Thrust; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Functional Ab + Leg Pump (12-15 min):
5mins As Many Reps as Possible AMRAP
5 Hand Release Burpees
7 Anchored Feet Sit Ups
12 Air Squats
rest 2mins x 2 Sets
Effort Note:
This is a bodyweight conditioning piece that will allow for a consistently high pace during the entire workout. Start at a sustainable pace and gradually build up throughout the first 5 minute AMRAP. For the second AMRAP complete as many total rounds and reps as possible.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 5th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:

Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Thursday, August 6th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Push Press
The dumbbell push press alternates with the Seated Filly Press across this cycle. The push press uses a small leg drive to move more load overhead than a strict press allows. Control the lowering phase on every rep. The eccentric is where the shoulder stimulus happens, not just on the way up. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Fatigued Shoulders based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Plyo Push Up; 5 reps
3. Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Push Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating DB Bench Press; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Tate Press; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Fatigued Shoulders (15 min):
800m Run
10 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up
50ft/side Mixed Front Rack Overhead DB Carry
400m Run
8 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up
50ft/side Mixed Front Rack Overhead DB Carry
200m Run
6 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up
50ft/side Mixed Front Rack Overhead DB Carry
*KB Weight Suggestion 53/35\# (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
This conditioning piece is highly fatiguing for the shoulders. If you are between weights, opt for a lighter weight. You break up the reps however needed, but try to keep rest minimal during the shoulder exercises. Use the row to catch your breath and allow your shoulders to recover.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
3. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, August 7th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Romanian Deadlift
The dumbbell Romanian deadlift alternates with the split stance version across this cycle. Both legs hinge together this week, which allows more total load on the hamstrings and glutes. The 31X1 tempo means three seconds down, one second pause at the bottom, then drive up. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, which means the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Carry Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Weight Plate Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
3. Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @31X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Glute Bridge Adductor Squeeze; 10 reps @20X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Plate Loaded Leg Behind Squat; 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Carry Conditioning (12-15 min):
2-3 Sets For Quality
40 Double Unders or 60 Single Unders
20 Box Jump Step Down
40 Double Unders or 60 Single Unders
30sec/side Single Arm Farmer's Walk
rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Select a weight that is challenging, but you are able to complete unbroken for at least the first set. Start this workout at a sustainable pace. Increase pace each round if you are feeling good.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Heel Sits; 10 reps
2. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, August 8th, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

2-3 Sets for Quality
- 30 sec Glute Bridge March
- 15 Tuck Ups
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
- 6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
- 20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip External Rotation
1. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
2. Supine Figure 4 Stretch x 1-2 min/side
3. Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side
5. Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5-10 reps/side
6. Elevated Pigeon Stretch x 1-2 min/side
7. Sidelying Active Hip ER x 5 reps/side

Sunday, August 9th, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST

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